In cases of failure by MSMEs to execute contracts during the Covid period, 95 per cent of the forfeited amount relating to bid or performance security will be returned to them by government and government undertakings

TOURISM



50 tourist destinations to be developed

Sector-specific skilling and entrepreneurship development to promote domestic tourism; tourism infrastructure and amenities to be created in border villages under the Vibrant Villages Programme

States will be encouraged to set up a Unity Mall for promotion and sale of their own ODOPs (one district, one product), GI products and other handicraft products

YOUTH



Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana 4.0 to skill the youth in next three years; the digital ecosystem for skilling will be further expanded

A pan-India National Apprenticeship Promotion Scheme to provide stipend to 4.7 million youth in the next three years

TRIBAL



To improve socio-economic conditions of the particularly vulnerable tribal groups (PVTGs), Pradhan Mantri PVTG Development Mission will be launched with Rs 15,000 crore allocated for the next three years

WOMEN



A one-time small savings scheme, Mahila Samman Savings Certificate, will be made available for a two-year period; Rs 2 lakh can be invested at fixed interest rate of 7.5 per cent

SENIOR CITIZENS



The maximum deposit limit for Senior Citizen Savings Scheme will be enhanced from Rs 15 lakh to Rs 30 lakh

The maximum deposit limit for Monthly Income Account Scheme will be enhanced from Rs 4.5 lakh to Rs 9 lakh for single account and from Rs 9 lakh to Rs 15 lakh for joint account

OTHER ANNOUNCEMENTS

A National Data Governance Policy to support innovation and research by start-ups and academia

To encourage indigenous production of Lab Grown Diamonds (LGD) seeds and machines and to reduce import dependency, a research and development grant will be provided to one of the IITs for five years; custom duty reduced for LGD seeds

500 new 'waste to wealth' plants under GOBARdhan (Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan) scheme will be established at an investment of Rs 10,000 crore

COUNT YOUR INCOME TAX

No tax for individuals earning up to Rs 7 lakh a year

The threshold limits for presumptive tax (the tax one pays based on presumed income) for eligible businesses raised from Rs 2 crore to Rs 3 crore and for specified professions from Rs 50 lakh to Rs 75 lakh

Life insurance policy maturity proceeds will be taxed if premium exceeds Rs 5 lakh a year

NEW REGIME

INCOME TAX SLABS	TAX RATE	SURCHARGE RATE	EFFECTIVE TAX RATE
Up to Rs 3 lakh	Nil	NA	NA
From Rs 3 lakh to 6 lakh	5%*	NA	5.20%
Rs 6 lakh to Rs 9 lakh	10%*	NA	10.40%
Rs 9 lakh to Rs 12 lakh	15%	NA	15.60%
Rs 12 lakh to Rs 15 lakh	20%	NA	20.80%
Rs 15 lakh to Rs 50 lakh	30%	NA	31.20%
Rs 50 lakh to Rs 1 crore	30%	10%	34.32%
Rs 1 crore to Rs 2 crore	30%	15%	35.88%
Rs 2 crore to Rs 5 crore	30%	25%^	39%
Rs 5 crore and above	30%	25%	39%

***Note**: The new regime will be the default regime. Benefits of the reduced tax rates can be availed if the individual forgoes prescribed deductions and exemptions; the new regime does not have provisions for higher exemption limits for senior citizens (over 60) and very senior citizens (over 80); *Rebate up to Rs 20,000 for resident individuals whose total income does not exceed Rs 7 lakh; ^surcharge rate is capped at 15% for long-term capital gains, short-term capital gains covered under section 111A and dividend income; 4% higher education cess applicable on income tax and surcharge payable; effective tax rate = tax rate plus surcharge if applicable + 4% higher education cess. Source: EY India*

OLD REGIME

INCOME TAX SLABS	TAX RATE	SURCHARGE RATE	EFFECTIVE TAX RATE
Up to Rs 2.5 lakh	Nil	NA	NA
Rs 2.5 lakh to Rs 5 lakh	5%*	NA	5.20%
Rs 5 lakh to Rs 10 lakh	20%	NA	20.80%
Rs 10 lakh to Rs 50 lakh	30%	NA	31.20%
Rs 50 lakh to Rs 1 crore	30%	10%	34.32%
Rs 1 crore to Rs 2 crore	30%	15%	35.88%
Rs 2 crore to Rs 5 crore	30%	25%^	39%
Rs 5 crore and above	30%	37%^	42.74%

***Note**: For individuals under the age of 60, the basic exemption limits are higher at Rs 3 lakh and Rs 5 lakh for senior citizens (over 60) and very senior citizens (over 80) respectively; *rebate up to Rs 12,500 for resident individuals whose total income does not exceed Rs 5 lakh; ^surcharge rate is capped at 15% for long-term capital gains, short-term capital gains covered under section 111A and dividend income; 4% higher education cess applicable on income tax and surcharge payable; effective tax rate = tax rate plus surcharge if applicable + 4% higher education cess. Source: EY India*